lesser issuance of FSBs (Rs 31,459 crore in RE2020–21 against Rs 49,500 crore planned in BE20–21—actual in 2019–20 only Rs 22,006 crore) and lesser lending from NSSF to fund the revenue expenditure of the government (Rs 94,636 crore in RE20–21 against planned Rs 1,36,600 in BE20–21).

As no issuance of FSBs was proposed for financial year 2021–22, this meant discontinuation of this mode of raising off-budget borrowing, initiated for the first time in India's fiscal management armoury and vocabulary in 2016–17. The Annexure also stated that funding from NSSF would be reduced to only Rs 30,000 crore in financial year 2021–22.

The off-budget expenditure of Rs 94,636 crore (as given in the Annexure to the Budget Speech) through NSSF in RE20–21 comprises two items: Rs 84,636 crore to FCI for food subsidy and Rs 10,000 crore to BMTPC, a special purpose vehicle (SPV) under the Ministry of Urban and Housing Affairs, for affordable housing subsidies.

Separately, the government revised the allocation for food subsidy to FCI (from Rs 77,983 crore in BE20–21 to Rs 3,44,077 crore in RE20–21) and for decentralized procurement (from Rs 37,337 crore in BE20–21 to Rs 78,338 crore in RE20–21). Taking all the provisions of food subsidy made in NSSF and the demands of the Department of Food and Public Distribution, the government enhanced the provision from Rs 2,51,920 crore in BE20–21 to Rs 5,07,051 crore in RE20–21, recording an increased food subsidy provision of Rs 2,55,131 crore. For financial year 2021–22, budget provision of Rs 2,42,616 crore has been provided for food subsidy.

The NSSF accounts presented further details about the loan payment from NSSF to FCI for food subsidy and the repayment of the NSSF loan. There was an opening balance of outstanding loans from NSSF to FCI for food subsidy of Rs 2,54,600 crore as on 1 April 2020. Further loans of Rs 84,636 crore were provided for in RE20–21 and repayments of Rs 2,20,524 crore were also included in the NSSF accounts. This would leave a balance